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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

‘You’re Dr. Phil’

TV personality says he joined immigration raids in Chicago for sake of ‘transparency’

By Dan Petrella, Nell Salzman and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

Partway through answering questions Sunday during an immigration enforcement blitz in Chicago, a man who appeared to be in federal custody briefly stopped talking when he recognized the man with the Texas accent asking the questions.

“You’re Dr. Phil,” the man said to television personality Phil McGraw, who, while standing alongside federal agents, peppered the man with questions about his citizenship and alleged crimes.

The scene played out not only in Chicago but across the internet

Sunday as McGraw and cameras from his Merit TV media platform were embedded with President Donald Trump’s “border czar” Tom Homan and others from various federal agencies as they began their long-promised immigration action in and around the city this past weekend.

Federal Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials did not respond to questions Monday about McGraw’s presence during the enforcement actions or the specifics of interactions with suspects that were disseminated on his platform and social media accounts. But in an interview with Tribune, McGraw,

Turn to Dr. Phil, Page 5



Phil McGraw, left, known as Dr. Phil, in an image from a video he posted to his X account walking with “border czar” Tom Homan on Sunday during an embed with federal immigration agents in Chicago. **DR. PHIL**

“Transparency is going to be important for people to understand what’s going on and what’s not going on.”

— Phil McGraw, television personality known as Dr. Phil

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

Defense argues to see ‘man,’ not ‘myth’

Key witness called ‘malignant tumor’ at heart of case

By Jason Meisner, Megan Crepeau and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

As his attorney wrapped up a marathon closing argument Monday, former House Speaker Michael Madigan sat stoic at the defense table, gazing at the jury with his usual legal pad and pencil at the ready.

“To me, he’s always been Mike,” attorney Daniel Collins said of the once-powerful and feared Democratic leader. “And there’s a reason for that. I see the man. I don’t see a myth. And I would beg you to see the man.”

As he did during most of the trial, Madigan betrayed little emotion at his lawyer’s personal flourish. After the jury left the courtroom, however, Madigan walked over to Collins and shook his hand, then broke into a smile and talked cheerfully with a group of supporters in the hallway.

The scene followed the final pitch by Madigan’s legal team as they try to convince the jury he’s innocent of sweeping racketeering charges alleging he sold his public office for private gain.

In his rigorous and sometimes forceful argument, which stretched over two days beginning Friday, Collins held little back, accusing prosecutors of engaging in “confirmation bias,” belittling Madigan’s co-defendant, Michael McClain, as a self-aggrandizing name-dropper, and calling FBI mole and former Ald. Daniel Solis the “malignant tumor at the heart of this case.”

Collins also urged the jury not to tap into the cynicism or suspicion that often accompanies public corruption cases and focus instead on the evidence, which he said failed to show Madigan ever acted with corrupt intent.

“Mike Madigan was not part of any racketeering enterprise,” Collins said near the end of his argument. “He was a public official who did his best. He’s made some mistakes, but he’s always tried to build consensus, to collaborate. That’s who he was. That’s who he tries to be.”

Turn to Madigan, Page 2



Former House Speaker Michael Madigan walks toward the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Thursday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Displaced Palestinians return to their homes on Monday in the northern Gaza Strip, following Israel’s decision to allow thousands of them to go back for the first time since the early weeks of the 15-month war with Hamas. **JEHAD ALSHRAFI/AP**

Thousands return to northern Gaza

Shattered section of territory reopens for first time since 2023

By Abdel Kareem Hana, Wafaa Shurafa and Samy Magdy
Associated Press

WADI GAZA, Gaza Strip — Hundreds of thousands of Palestinians streamed into Gaza’s most heavily destroyed area on Monday after Israel opened the

north for the first time since the early weeks of the war with Hamas, a dramatic reversal of their exodus 15 months ago.

As a fragile ceasefire held into a second week, Israel was told by Iran-backed Hamas that eight of the hostages to be freed during the deal’s first phase are dead.

Along a seaside road, joyous

crowds of Palestinians, some holding babies or pushing wheelchairs, walked all day and into the night, carrying bedrolls, bottles of water and other belongings. Armed and masked Hamas fighters flashed a victory sign. The crowd was watched over by Israeli tanks on a nearby hill.

The United Nations said over 200,000 people were observed moving north on Monday morning.

Palestinians who have been

sheltering in squalid tent camps and former schools are eager to return to their homes — even though they are likely damaged or destroyed. Many had feared that Israel would make their displacement permanent.

Yasmin Abu Amshah, a mother of three, said she walked nearly 4 miles to reach her damaged but habitable Gaza City home. She saw her younger sister for the

Turn to Gaza, Page 9

Ill. EPA opposes proposed toxic waste dump growth on Southeast Side

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

In a letter filed in federal court, the Illinois Environmental Protection Agency said the proposed expansion of a toxic waste dump on the Southeast Side would go against state law. It’s the latest development in a lengthy battle over the future of a 45-acre disposal site on the Lake Michi-

gan shoreline.

“This is a major win for our community, to have both the Illinois attorney general and the Illinois EPA say that the expansion of this toxic landfill will not be (approved),” said Amalia NietoGomez, executive director of social justice nonprofit Alliance of the Southeast.

Since 1984, the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers has been dumping

toxic sediment dredged from the Calumet River into the now-full containment site, which contains mercury, arsenic and polychlorinated biphenyls or PBCs. After reaching capacity or after 10 years, whichever came first, the property was to be returned to the Chicago Park District to restore as a park for the largely Black and Latino community.

Four decades later, the prop-

erty hasn’t been turned over to the community, and the Army Corps wants to raise the dump 25 feet, piling an additional 1 million cubic yards of toxic sediment over another 20 years. In 2023, the Alliance of the Southeast and Friends of the Parks sued the Army Corps to stop the expansion.

So far, the Illinois EPA has denied the federal agency all of the state water quality permits it

would need to proceed. The state’s Attorney General Kwame Raoul has also staunchly opposed the proposed project; in 2024 he filed an amicus brief in support of turning the dump into a public park.

More recently on Jan. 16, Raoul filed — alongside a supplemental brief with the U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Illi-

Turn to Dump, Page 4

What happened at Hamline?

Fear regarding looming deportations following President Donald Trump’s return to office came to a head Friday. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Yuengling on tap in Illinois

About 2,000 bars and restaurants across the state now are able to pour Yuengling beer, which for the first 195 years of its history was unavailable in Illinois. **Business**

Commemorating Auschwitz

Dozens of world leaders joined a dwindling group of Nazi death camp survivors to commemorate the 80th anniversary of the liberation of Auschwitz. **Nation & World**

